3.4 Developing minimal data products

With your Messflix implementation teams selected and the data governance team's decision on governance principles, it is high time for you to start work on data products. To do that, you need to do the following:

1. Identify candidate datasets.
2. Appoint data product owners.
3. Ensure that data products adhere to your data governance policy:
    - Prepare data product searchable descriptions.
    - Expose the data in a controlled manner.

This section walks through each of these steps and identifies techniques for effective execution.

3.4.1 Identifying domain-oriented datasets

At the MVP stage, to select datasets to be exposed in the form of data products, you should identify data already fulfilling or close to fulfilling the minimal data product requirements. The heuristics for the selection of a suitable dataset can be based on the following criteria:

- It's focused on a single domain.
- It's richly described with metadata.
- It has clearly defined access ports.

To improve the business impact of data product candidate selection, you can add more criteria. For example, you may decide to focus on adding value to your MVP by selecting, for example, systems regularly exposing the data for use by other systems or datasets underutilized in the business because of findability/access concerns.

DEFINITION A *domain* in domain-driven design, which is conceptually closely related to a data mesh, is defined simply as an area of interest. For now, think of domains as cohesive business areas. For example, the domain may be sales, accounting, or procurement.